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Additions in 1.1:

- Example provided regarding [sing] tags, see [Special Cases: Laughter, Singing & Foreign Language Songs](#)
- Example provided regarding English words being spoken, see: [Foreign Language in Audio](#)
- Example provided regarding numbers over 1 million, see: [Numbers](#)
- Exception and Example provided regarding cut-off numbers see: [Numbers](#)

Jigglypuff Production Guidelines

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Segmentation Guidelines

Overview

For the first portion of this task, you will use a conversation annotation tool to label when each speaker talks or when a noise occurs. Regions will be created on a visual timeline known as a waveform. Each unit will come pre-populated with segments for speakers, as well as non speaker noise.

Your task consists of:

1. **Listening** to the entire audio segment.
 - a. Tip: 🎧 Wear headphones to increase listening accuracy!
2. **Creating regions** on the waveform for each speaker or non-speaker noise (e.g., background noise) that are missing.
3. **Changing regions** on the waveform for each speaker or non-speaker that are incorrect (cut off words, incorrect speaker labeled,
4. **Labeling regions** as either **Speaker** (for speech and speaker sounds) or **Noise** (Noise not made by a speaker, but is audible)

Key Terms

TERM	DEFINITION
Unit	A single page in the ADAP job.
Segment	A short portion of audio that contains speech or non-speech sounds, shown in the waveform

Region

A portion of a segment where either a speaker talks or a noise occurs.
Usually corresponds to a single conversational turn.

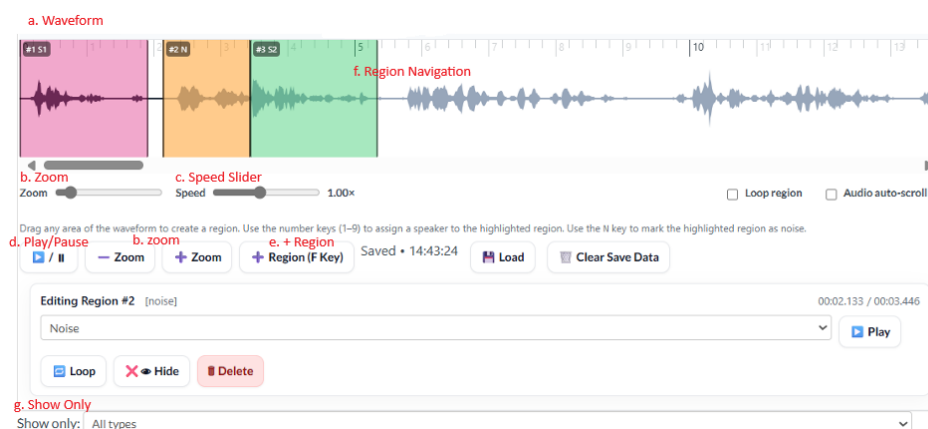
Tool Overview

These are the key interface elements in the annotation tool:

Audio Player & Waveform Controls

- Waveform:** Visual representation of audio.
- Zoom:** Zoom in/out to observe audio detail.
- Speed Slider:** Adjust playback speed.
- Play/Pause:** Play or pause the audio.
- + Region:** Add a new region (for speech or noise).
- Region Navigation:** Click and drag edges of regions to adjust timing.
- Show Only:** Toggle visibility of specific region types.

The screenshot below shows key features of the tool, including the waveform, zoom and speed controls, region creation, boundary adjustment, and filtering by region type.



Regions Table

As you segment regions, they appear in the Regions Table with details:

- **Type:** The category of the region: Speaker or Noise.
- **Actions:** Tools for region editing:
 -  **Search:** Zoom into the selected region.
 -  **Play:** Play audio segment of the region.
 -  **Hide:** Temporarily hide region (useful for overlapping edits).
 -  **Delete:** Remove the region.

The screenshot below illustrates the Regions Table, showing how each region is categorized by **Type** (e.g., Speaker or Noise) and the available **Actions**, including zoom, play, hide, and delete.

Regions

#	Type	Actions
1	Speaker 1	   
2	Noise	   
3	Speaker 2	   



Workflow Instructions

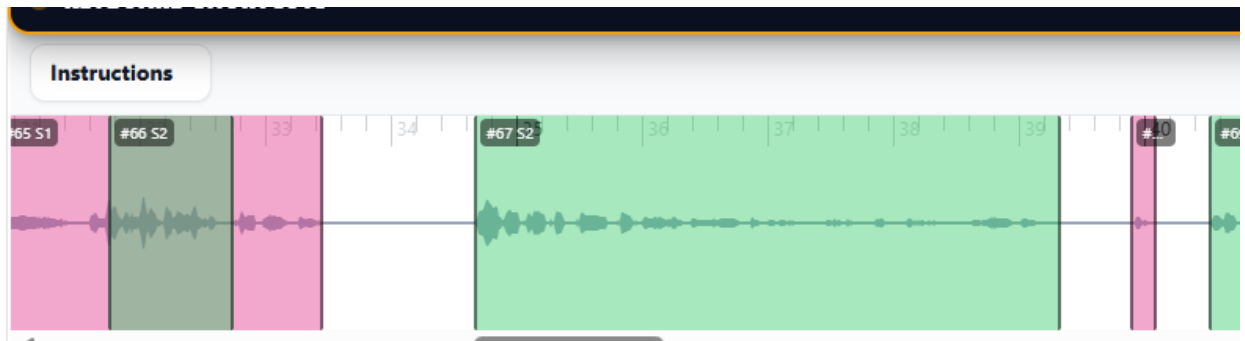
Step 1: Creating and Editing Regions

1. Begin by listening to the full audio segment.
2. Create regions for speaker turns and non-speaker noises.

General Guidelines

- Each speaker turn and non-speaker noise needs a separate region. Skip overlapping speaker noises only if they are very short and meet the noise criteria. (see Noise guidance below).
- Ensure region selections are accurate. If unsure, it's better to extend than cut off a region.
- If one speaker turn is long, split these long regions logically (e.g., at pauses or change in topics) when you can be confident that the natural pauses of the speech mean you are not making segments that cut people off mid-word or mid-sentence.

- **Do not include pauses longer than 2 seconds within a region.**
 - But try to split regions in clear pauses when confident – this is more important than the “length” of the pause
- If there is no audio in part of the clip, you can leave it blank. You do not need to create a region for silence. The screenshot below shows correct examples of areas with no audio.



Creating and Editing Regions

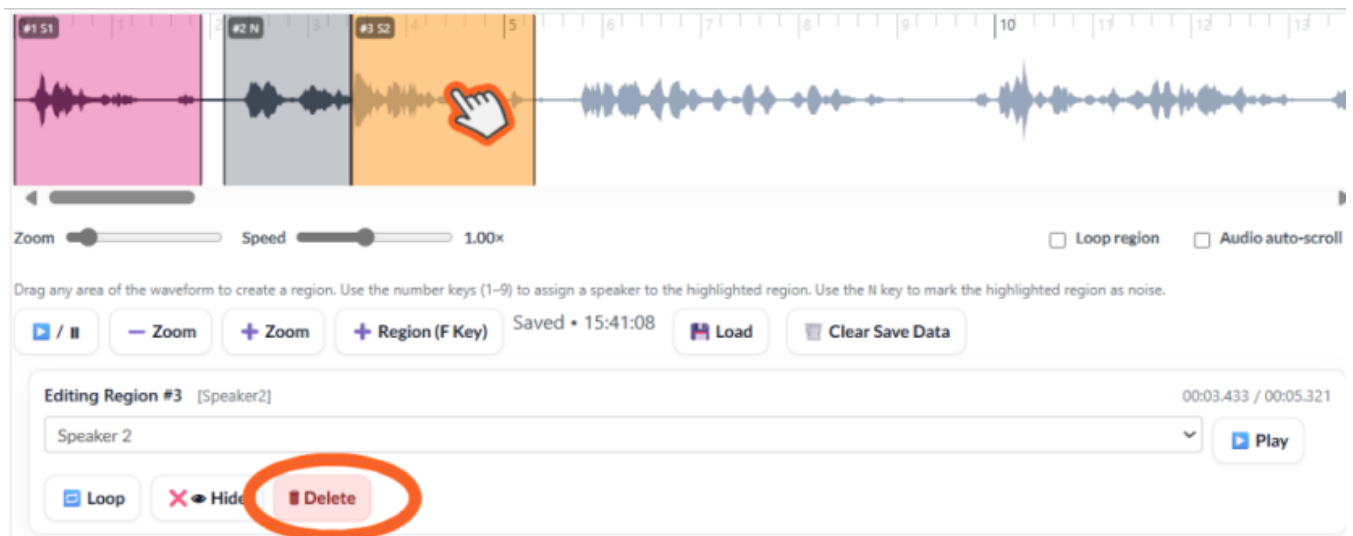
- To create:
 - Click on the Waveform at the desired start point and click **+Region**,
 - Or, simply **press the "F" key** as a shortcut to create a new region.



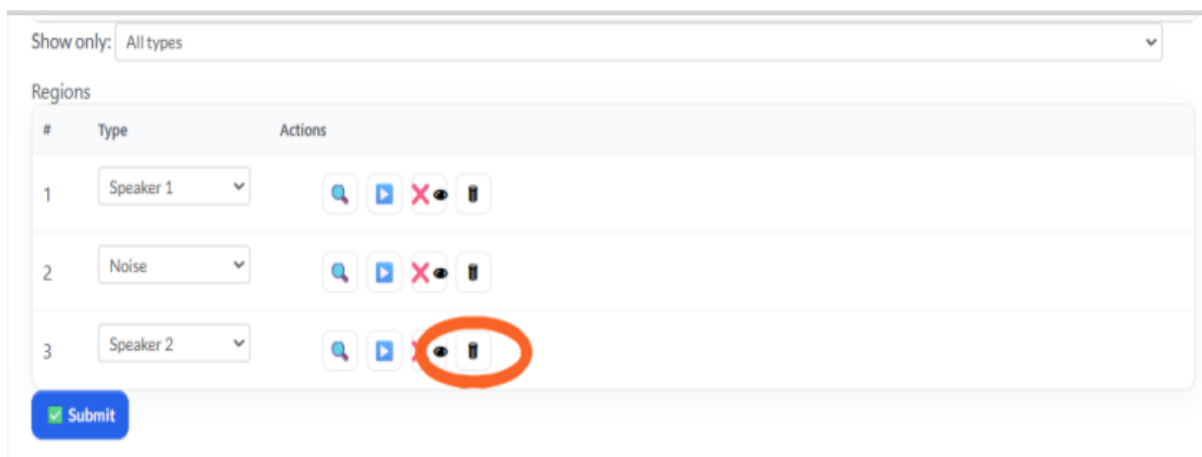
- To edit:
 - Drag borders of selected region on the Waveform.



- To delete:
 - From Waveform: Click region → click **Delete**.

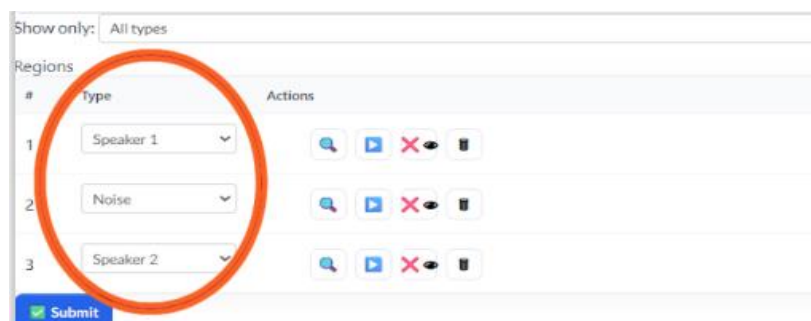


- From Regions Table: Locate region → click **Delete**.



Step 2: Labeling Regions (Type Field)

Label each region with its appropriate Type: a speaker (e.g., “Speaker 1”) or *Noise*.



General Guidelines

- Speakers must maintain consistent identifiers across regions.
- Each region can have only one type: either a speaker or a noise.
- If you're unsure which speaker is talking:
 - Make your best guess based on voice/tone.
 - If ambiguity remains, assign a new speaker identifier. The priority is to show a speaker change.
- For more than one speaker in a segment, use distinct identifiers: "Speaker 1", "Speaker 2", etc.

Special Cases

- **Speaker impersonations:** If a speaker performs different voices (narrating or dramatizing), assign a unique speaker type to each character.

Example: A speaker narrating a conversation switches between two voices noticeably. Assign one region and identifier to the narrator and separate regions and identifiers for each character's voice.

Segmentation Best Practices

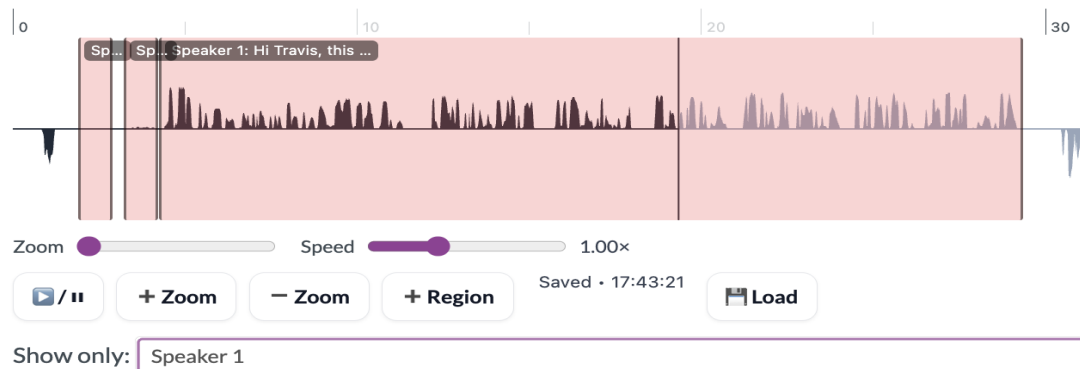
Speaker Regions

- **Overlapping speakers:**
 - Create a region for each speaker, even if their speech overlaps.
 - If people talk over each other and it can't be understood, they should still be tagged as overlapping speaker regions and **not** noise
 - Overlaps are correct and required.
 - Use **Show Only** to isolate Speaker region views when editing overlaps.
 - **Overlapping regions for the SAME speaker are not allowed and will trigger errors.**

Annotating Overlapping Speakers: Step-by-Step Example

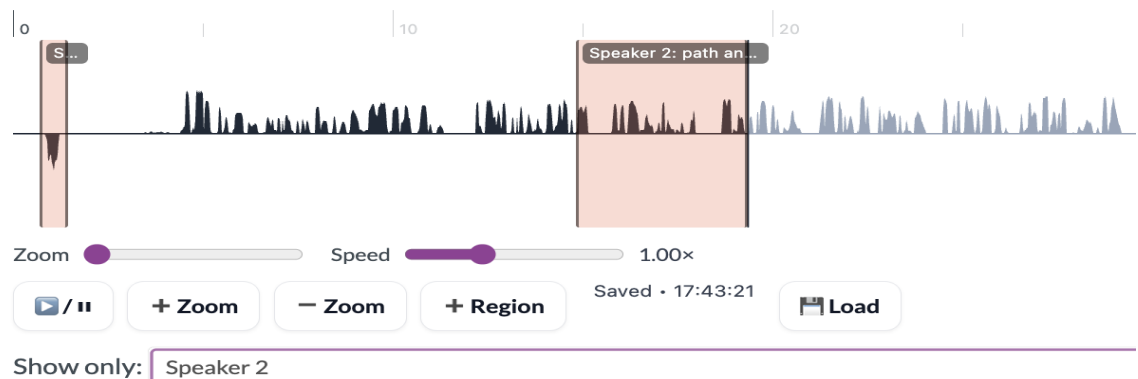
1. Create Speaker 1's region

- a. In this example, Speaker 1 begins with “Hi Travis...”. Their speech extends continuously, even though they’re interrupted.



2. Add Speaker 2's region

- a. Speaker 2 interrupts Speaker 1 midway, but **Speaker 1 does not stop speaking**.
- b. Because of this overlap, a separate region for Speaker 2 must be placed on top of Speaker 1's.
- c. To make editing easier, **temporarily hide other regions** using the filter (e.g., show only Speaker 2's region). This provides a blank canvas to annotate with better accuracy.



3. Review all overlapping regions

- a. Once you've created both regions, set the display to "**All types**" to review how the overlapping segments appear together and confirm proper alignment.



Handling Overlapping Noise and Speech

Situations with overlapping **speaker speech** and **non-speaker noise**, or **two overlapping noise types**, follow the same approach:

- **All eligible overlapping sounds* must be segmented.**
- **Note:** While overlapping regions across **different speakers or noise types** are allowed (and often necessary), **regions for the same speaker should never overlap**. If two regions with the same speaker label overlap, you will receive an error.

Short Turns and Verbal Noises

- If a speaker makes a verbal noise, a region must be created for the speaker.
Verbal noises include, but are not limited to, laughter, whistling, coughing, and sneezing.

Example: If two people (or more) are having a back-and-forth conversation, and there are audible breaks between speakers, new regions should be created, even if the break is very short (1 second or less).

INCORRECT

One speaker region with an overlap



CORRECT

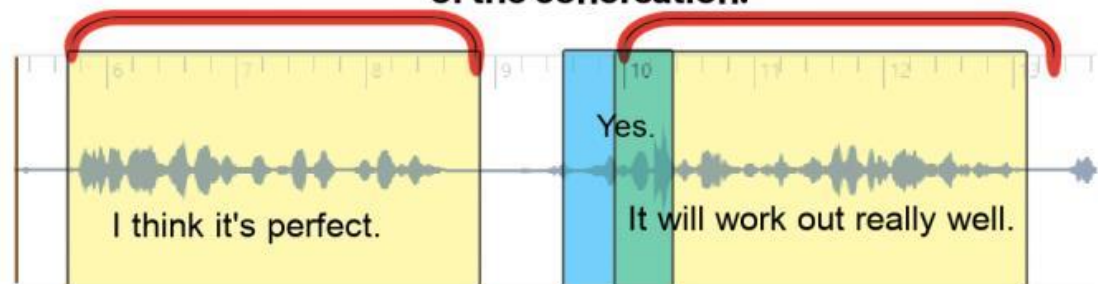
Break the long region into shorter regions.
The segmentation is done according to the flow
of the conversation.



This will also apply if there is a true overlap in the conversation.

CORRECT

Break the long region into shorter regions.
The segmentation is done according to the flow
of the conversation.



Note: This guidance also applies to verbal utterances ("umm," "ah-ha", etc) and laughter.

Non-Speaker Noise Regions

Non-speaker noises are sounds made by something **other than someone actively speaking in the conversation** (e.g., ringing, paper crinkling, music, WhatsApp chime, baby crying). **All eligible non-speaker noises must have their own regions labeled as Noise.**

Eligible Non-Speaker Noises

- Non-speaker noises **should** be annotated when:
 - It is relevant to the speech (it would be included in a subtitle)
[crowd laughing], [background music], [applause], [audience murmuring]
 - It interferes with the speech, or it is as loud as the speech (the AI should ignore it for subtitling)
[bang], [loud rustling sound], [knock on desk]
- Non-speaker noises **should not** be segmented when they are quiet and/or irrelevant background sounds
 - If the speech can be **clearly heard** over the noise in the background and the noise is not relevant to the speech (e.g. sound effects for a story being told even if quiet behind the voice is relevant), they should not be tagged.

Quiet static, distant traffic sounds, quiet rustling, light footsteps in the background, light wind

Guidelines

- **Non-speaker noise regions CAN overlap** with speaker regions.
 - **Example:** If a knocking sound occurs while a speaker is talking, create a *Noise* region that spans the entire duration of the knocking, even if it overlaps with the speaker's region.
- **Background music must be annotated** with separate *Noise* regions.
 - **Example:** If the same music plays throughout the entire audio segment, you must create one or more *Noise* regions to cover it completely.
 - If the music changes between soundtracks, they should be separate regions
 - Singers in background music should be part of the music's Noise tag, **not** speech
- **Break long non-speaker noise into regions ≤ 25 seconds.**
 - **Example:** If background music lasts 90 seconds, divide it into **four consecutive Noise regions**, each no longer than 25 seconds.



- Ignore very short, non-repetitive noises **if they are difficult to capture** in the waveform.
Please note: This rule only applies to noise, not speech.
 - **Example:** A single, quiet knock or beep during someone's speech that is too small to select accurately can be skipped.
 - Exception: **Loud** but short noises should still have their own regions
- **Canned or pre-recorded laughter** (e.g., sitcom laugh tracks) must be segmented as Noise.
- **Live audience laughter** (three or more voices and not attributable to an individual speaker) must also be segmented as Noise.
- **Singing** an unidentifiable person or pre-recorded music (even if lyrical) must be segmented as Noise.

Segmentation Summary

Review and apply the following quality and accuracy checks before submitting your segmentation work. These steps help ensure that your annotations are complete, consistent, and aligned with current standards.

- Listen to the full audio before labeling.
- Use zoom and speed controls for clarity.
- Ensure every speaker turn and noise is captured.
- Verify speaker labels are consistent throughout.
- Regions must not exceed 25 seconds.
- Do not include pauses longer than 2 seconds in a region.
- No overlapping regions for the same speaker.
- Properly segment overlapping speech or noise.
- Use noise segments for non-speech sounds.
- Canned or pre-recorded laughter: label the **region** as Noise and transcribe [canned laughter]
- Live audience laughter (3+ voices): label the **region** as Noise and transcribe [crowd laughing]

- Align region boundaries with speech in the audio.
- No cut-off words or extra content from adjacent segments.

Transcription Guidelines

 **IMPORTANT:** You should never add speaker labels like Speaker 1, Speaker 2 in the transcript box. This is not part of the task and goes against the transcription guidelines.

Your job is to transcribe exactly what is heard, without adding any extra information.

What to Do Instead:

- Transcribe what is heard in each segment. This includes both Speaker segments, and Noise segments.
- For overlapping speech where multiple speakers are talking over each other – see the section on <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tags.

Don't Do This (Incorrect Examples):

Please **do not** add speaker tags in this way:

- <nonprimaryspeakertalking>Speaker 1: Pedro Castral! Pedro Castral! Speaker 2: Se eu já lhe...</nonprimaryspeakertalking>
- Speaker 1: Solta a vinheta.
- [background music] Speaker 1: Não queria fazer, então me pediu um <unintelligible/>. <nonprimaryspeakertalking>Speaker 2: E pagaram. Speaker 3: E pagaram. Speaker 1: Pagaram. Speaker 4: [laugh] Speaker 1: E eu pensei assim</nonprimaryspeakertalking>,vou dificultar mais a situação...

These examples are incorrect because they include speaker labels like "Speaker 1" and "Speaker 2," which should not be written into the transcript.

Note: There may be several other issues with this unit. Here, we are only demonstrating the speaker label mistake. Do not assume that other errors are acceptable.

Correct Way:

- If only one person is speaking, simply transcribe their dialogue without a speaker label: *Pedro Castral!*

Transcription Accuracy

Please be sure to use correct spelling and punctuation, unless the speaker stutters, trails off, or manipulates their speech in another way. **Make sure to spell the names of places and famous people correctly.** Research the spelling if you are not sure.

Transcribe speech **exactly as spoken**, including:

- Stutters (*d- d- did you do that?*)
- Disfluencies (*um, uh, oh*)
- Elided words (*stayin', nat'ral*)
- Reduced form words (*gonna, wanna, gotta*)
- Repeated or partial words

Example: *And, and wh- what did they tell you?* I gotta get to the uh, store.

Stutters and Truncated Words

- Hyphen (-) is used for stutters or cut/truncated words.
 - *I went to the d- d- doctor.*
 - *What the he- ?*

Trail offs and Pauses

- Ellipsis (...) is used for pauses or trail offs. Do not use them for truncated words.
 - *I was thinking... But then I knew better.*
 - *It was an amazing trick. How did...*

Elided Speech – Dropped Letters and Syllables

- Apostrophes are used to designate dropped or swallowed letters and syllables in words. This signals to the auditor that the spelling is an intentional representation of the speaker's voice and not a misspelling.

- We were **huntin'** and **fishin'** all weekend.
- Give **'em** what they want.
- I'm **'bout** ready to go.

Ambiguous, Foreign, or Code-Switching Words

- If a word is unclear but you can reasonably guess it, wrap it in hashtags (#):

Example: I like your #blue#

- If a foreign or code-switched word is used (i.e., it does not exist in the target language), transcribe it literally and wrap the word in hashtags:

Example: They really need a #zeitgeist#.

- Only include hashtag formatting if the word clearly comes from a different language and has no native equivalent. Do not use hashtags for borrowed or naturalized words that are commonly used in the target language.
- If a word is completely unintelligible, use the <unintelligible/> tag.

(See Section: General Tagging Instructions.)

Capitalization and Punctuation

- Use **standard punctuation** and **grammar rules** of the target language: Include commas, exclamation marks, question marks, periods, quotation marks, etc.
- **Do not use both an exclamation mark with a question mark.** Exclamation marks supersede question marks when both could apply.
- Use punctuation to reflect the speaker's intent or tone — even if grammatically incorrect. If something sounds like a question, **use a question mark**.

Examples:

- *Did you see the game last night?*
- *Did you see that!* (spoken excitedly)
- *She's not going?* (spoken with a rising tone)

Emphasis and Elongated Syllables

- Use emphasis and vowel lengthening only when clearly noticeable in the audio. If you're unsure, do not include it.

- To show emphasis, capitalize the emphasized word and surround it with three asterisks on each side:

Example: I cannot ***BELIEVE*** she said that!

- **Note:** For languages where capitalization is not standard such as in script (HI, JP, AR, etc), capitalization isn't needed and wrap the word in *** like above to transcribe emphasized words.
- To indicate a drawn-out (elongated) vowel sound (in a single word), wrap only the elongated portion using asterisks (*):

✓ **Correct:** That was so c*u*te!

✗ **Incorrect:** cuuuute / cuuuute / cuuute

- Keep vowel stretching realistic: do not exaggerate lengthened vowels beyond what is heard.

Note: Be consistent in this format throughout your transcript:

- Use single asterisks only for vowel elongation
- Avoid using elongated vowels without asterisks or inside multiple asterisks (e.g., mixing styles like hello, helloooo, etc.)

Pauses and Trailing Thoughts

Use an **ellipsis (...)** to show pauses or incomplete thoughts.

Examples:

- But I didn't get to go to...
- *The speaker trails off after "to" without finishing the sentence.*
- When she left the store...she left very angry.
- *There is a brief pause after "store" before the speaker continues.*

Disfluencies and Fillers

Use the most **common spelling** for filler sounds in the **target language**.

Examples:

- If "umm" is most common for hesitation in the language, use "umm"

- Avoid mixing styles like "umm", "um", "uhm", "uhh", and "äää" in the same job

Numbers

Always write numbers using **Arabic numerals** (i.e., digits), not words.

Examples:

- *The time is 7:30.*
- *It happened in 2025.*
- *The total was 12 dollars and 99 cents.*
- *The combined amount was around 17 million.*
 - Note: for spoken words containing “million” and “billion”, write the numeral as well as the word like shown above.
 -  17 million
 17,000,000

Exception: If the spoken number is cut off during speech, transcribe the word as heard with a hyphen at the cut-off. **This is the only time a number should be transcribed phonetically.**

Example:

- I counted a total of sevent-
- The year was nineteen for-
- The price tag said it was only fifteen thir-

Websites

Write website addresses as they appear online **without spaces** and use proper formatting with symbols.

Examples:

- www.google.com
- *google.com*
- *thegreatcoursesplus.com*

Special Characters

Use the actual **symbol** for special characters rather than spell them out. For dollar amounts, spell out “dollars” instead of using the "\$" symbol, as the tool does not support it.

Examples:

- ☒ *She gave me 7%.*
☒ *She gave me seven percent.*
- ☒ *The party was fun/weird.*
☒ *The party was fun slash weird.*
- ☒ *You owe me 200 dollars!*
☒ *You owe me \$200!*

Abbreviations

Write abbreviations **as they are spoken**, not using shortened written forms.

Examples:

- ☒ *Mister Johnson*
☒ *Mr. Johnson*
- ☒ *Doctor Smith*
☒ *Dr. Smith*
- ☒ *Elisabeth Street*
☒ *Elisabeth St.*

Acronyms

Acronyms are formed from the first letters of words and are **pronounced as a single word**. Always write acronyms in **all capital letters** with **no spaces or periods**.

Examples:

- ☒ *NASA*
☒ *N.A.S.A.*
- ☒ *NATO*
☒ *N.A.T.O.*

Initialisms and Spelled-Out Words

Initialisms (letters pronounced individually) and any words that the speaker spells out should also be written in **all capital letters**, with **no spaces or periods**.

Examples:

- ☒ *IBM*
- ☒ *US*
- ☒ *JAMIE* — *used when the speaker verbally spells out the name "Jamie"*

Tags General Instructions

Tagging Non-Speech Sounds

Tag all speaker made **non-speech sounds** using brackets [], and write them in the **target language** of the job.

Example:

- English: [cough]
- French: [toux]
- Spanish: [tos]
- German: [husten]

Speaker-Made Non-Speech Sounds

If the **speaker** coughs, burps, sniffs, laughs, etc., the sound must be tagged **within their transcription**. Speaker-made sounds also are written in the **target language** of the job.

Example:

Speaker 1: They're not [sniff] sure what to do [sniff].

Speaker 2: Oh, my. [laugh] That's hysterical! [laugh]

- Any noise created by a **speaker** should be inserted within their speech.
 - **Example:**

- *Speaker 1: Then you have to put the flour [cough] in the bowl.*

Make sure the noise belongs to the same speaker in the segment. If another person makes the noise, **do not** tag it within this region.

Noise-Only Segments

When transcribing a "**Noise**," segment - **tag the dominant background sound** only. Noise segments also must be written in the **target language** of the job.

Do not transcribe speech in Noise segments.

These segments often contain noticeable background sounds such as **music, engine noise, static, crowd laughter, or distant conversations**. Even if you hear faint or unclear speech you should **not transcribe it in a noise segment**, since the main purpose of noise segments is to label **non-speech audio**.

☒ **What to Do:** Tag only the **main background sound** using square brackets [].

Sounds not produced by a speaker (e.g., WhatsApp chimes, ringing phones) should be marked with the **Noise** tag.

- These may **overlap** with speaker regions. (no <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tags are necessary for non-speaker sounds)
- Each individual noise within a region should be tagged separately.

Examples:

What you hear	What to tag
Music in the background	[background music]
A crowd laughing	[crowd laughing]
Muffled talking	[distant background speech]

Car engine running [engine noise]

Static or white noise [static]

You only need **one** tag for the sound that takes up **most of the clip**.

✗ What Not to Do:

- **Do not transcribe** any speech, even if some words are audible.
- **Do not guess** or create dialogue from faint voices.
- **Do not include speaker sounds in Noise segments**

Do Not Use Emojis for Tags

Tags must be plain text surrounded by brackets.

Example:

- ☒ **Correct:** [meow]
- ☐ **Incorrect:** 🐱

Please be aware that mobile devices often automatically turn symbols into emojis. Mobile devices are not recommended for this project.

Transcribing Breaths

- Only tag **clearly audible and distinct** breaths.
- Do **not** tag faint or normal conversational breaths.
- **Avoid** over-annotating breathing sounds.

Special Cases: Laughter, Singing & Foreign Language Songs

The following instructions apply to ambiguous or complex cases of laughter, singing, or foreign-language audio:

1. Canned (Pre-recorded) Laughter

- If you hear laughter that is clearly canned or synthetic (e.g. a sitcom laugh track), you should:
 - Label the audio segment with the [noise] label (i.e., it's not attributed to a speaker).
 - Annotate the transcript with [canned laughter].
 - **Example:**
Segment label: [noise]
Transcript: [canned laughter]

2. Live Audience Laughter (Three or More Voices)

- If laughter comes from a live studio crowd or a group of people (3 or more), and you cannot confidently assign it to a speaker:
 - Label the segment as [noise].
 - Use an appropriate transcript tag: [crowd laughing].
 - **Example:**
Segment label: [noise]
Transcript: [crowd laughing]

3. Main Speaker Singing (Spoken Context)

- If the main speaker begins singing during an interview or spontaneous speech:
 - Transcribe the lyrics normally inside their speaker-labeled segment.
 - Tag the beginning of the singing with a [sings] label or specific [sings *Song Title*].
 - Do not treat this as a [noise] segment.
 - **Example:**
Segment label: Speaker 1
Transcript: [sings Happy Birthday to You] Happy Birthday to you. Happy Birthday to you. Happy Birthday dear Paul. Happy Birthday to you.
 - **Note:** Once singing is complete and returns to normal speech – start a new segment. **Do not wrap with a 2nd [sings] tag.**

4. Foreign Language Singing (Recognizable Songs)

- If someone is clearly singing a recognizable song in a foreign language:
 - Use the speaker label.
 - Do not tag it as [foreign].
 - Instead, annotate it as [sings "Song Title"] if the lyrics are known, or [sings foreign song] if not.

- **Example:**
Segment label: Speaker 1
Transcript: [sings Nessun Dorma] or Transcript: [sings foreign song]
- **Note:** This overrides standard foreign-language tagging when singing is clearly recognized and melodic.

List of Tags

- Write **all tags** in the **target language** of the job **except** **<unintelligible/>**, **[foreign]**, and **<nonprimaryspeakertalking>** which should always remain in English.
- All other tags should be:
 - ☒ Placed inside **square brackets []**
 - ☒ **Localized** to the correct language
 - ☒ **Short but clearly descriptive**
- *Examples:* **[whatsapp chime]**, **[nails on chalkboard]**
- **Stay consistent** with how you use and translate tags across all segments and units, especially for:
 - **<unintelligible/>**
 - **[foreign]**
 - Any other sound that repeats (e.g., **[laugh]**, **[cough]**, **[ring]**)

Tag List 1: Unclear Language

Tag	Description	Example
<unintelligible/>	For speech that is completely unclear and can't be guessed	<i>I really felt very <unintelligible/> came by the house.</i>

- For any speech that is completely unclear and can't be guessed – **<unintelligible>** is used. Always in English (no translation), always inside of **< >** brackets.

Tag List 2: Speaker Sounds

These are used **in the region of the speaker** who made the sound. Please make sure to use your assigned language when using these tags.

Tag	Description
[foreign]	Use when foreign language is spoken, but you can't identify which one
[Spanish] / [Hindi] / etc.	Use when you can identify the spoken language. Make sure to localize the tag (see explanation below).
[laugh]	A speaker laughs
[clears throat]	A speaker clears their throat
[sigh]	A speaker sighs
[snort]	A speaker snorts
[cry]	A speaker cries
[lip smack]	Lip-smacking sound

[breath]	Loud/clear breath
[cough]	A speaker coughs
[sings]	Main speaker singing a song
[sings "Song Title"]	Optional specific title annotation when lyrics are known

These tags are used in the region of the speaker who made the sound. **Make sure to write all tags in your assigned language except <unintelligible/>, [foreign], and <nonprimaryspeakertalking> which should remain in English.**

Examples:

- English: [laugh]
- French: [rires]
- Spanish: [risa]
- German: [lachen]

Do not copy tags from examples unless they match your project's language.

Foreign Language in Audio

- If a speaker uses a **foreign language** that is **not the target language** of the job **and not English**, use a language tag:
 - Use **[foreign]** if you **can't identify** the language.
 - If you **can identify** the language, use a specific tag:
 - Example: **[French]**, **[Spanish]**, **[Hindi]**
 - **Exception to the foreign language tag:** If a person is singing a recognizable foreign language song, then tag the song instead.

- *[sings Nessun Dorma]*
- *[sings Frère Jacques]*
- **Localize** the language tag based on the target job language:
 - For example, in a German job, Arabic speech should be tagged as **[Arabisch]** (the German word for "Arabic")
- If the speaker is speaking **English**, do not tag it. Just **transcribe English speech as normal**.
 - Example: "इस खाने को **pizza** कहा जाता है?"

Language Tagging Summary

- All **target language speech** → Transcribe normally
- All **English speech** → Transcribe normally **in English**
- All **other languages** → Tag, don't transcribe
 - e.g., **[Japanese]**, **[Arabisch]** (Arabic in German)

Tag List 3: Non-Speaker Sounds

Use these in **Noise** segments. **Remember to translate them into your assigned language.**

Tag	Description
[click]	Clicking sound
[ring]	Ringling noise (e.g. phone)
[knock]	Knocking sound
[bang]	Loud bang

[dial tone]	Dial tone from a telephone
[distant background speech]	Voices in the far background
[distant background noise]	Unclear far-off noise
[unidentified noise]	Unclear but near noise
[echo]	Echo effect
[car engine]	Sound of a car motor running
[static]	Electrical static/crackle
[canned laughter]	Pre-recorded/artificial laughter from media or shows (segmented as [noise])
[crowd laughing]	Laughter from three or more people, typically audience or group response (segmented as [noise])

Speech Style

Speech Style describes **how** a speaker says something, based on tone, expression, and emotion.

Guidelines for Tagging Speech Style

- Only fill out the Speech Style field if the speaker's tone is **unmistakable and clearly expressed** (e.g., *whispering, screaming, sad, happy*).
- If the emotional tone or style is not obvious, **leave the Speech Style box empty**.
- Do not overanalyze. You should be able to identify the style **quickly and confidently**.
- Use **vocal features** (tone, pitch, intensity) to guide your choice. Not the content or topic of what is being said.

- Most segments will not require a speech style. Only use this field when it stands out clearly.
- Enter styles in the **target language** of the job, using the **default form** (usually masculine or neutral) if the language has gendered words.

Your entry must be:

- Concise (1–3 words)
- Free of uncommon slang
- Correctly spelled
- Not repetitive (e.g., use *very angry* or *furious*, not *angrily furious*)

Example Speech Styles

- Excited
- Angry
- Disgusted
- Surprised
- Confident
- Nervous
- Bored
- Whispering
- Crying
- Screaming

Accent Selection

Key Terms

Term	Definition
Locale	A country-level or standardized regional dialect (e.g., “English (United States): en-US”)

Accent Description A more specific regional variation (e.g., "Northeast", "Yucatán", "Southern California")

Sample Audio Audio clip of a speaker used to identify the locale and optional accent description

Tool Overview

For each unit, you'll see a **Speaker Locale Identification** interface. This includes:

- A list of **Speakers**
- A **Locale dropdown** menu
- An **Accent Description** input field

The screenshot below shows key features of the tool, including the speaker list, locale dropdown, accent description field, sample playback button, and submission confirmation checkbox.

Speaker Locale Identification

Speaker	Locale	Accent Description
Speaker1	Czech (CS) – cs-CS	If recognizable: e.g., Texan, Sicilian, Liverpool, North Germany...
Speaker2	Czech (CS) – cs-CS	If recognizable: e.g., Texan, Sicilian, Liverpool, North Germany...
Speaker3	Czech (CS) – cs-CS	If recognizable: e.g., Texan, Sicilian, Liverpool, North Germany...
Speaker4	Czech (CS) – cs-CS	If recognizable: e.g., Texan, Sicilian, Liverpool, North Germany...

☐ I have reviewed every speaker's accent, added recognizable accent info, and verified sample playback.

☒ Submit

Steps

- From the **Locale dropdown**, select the dialect locale that best matches the speaker's accent.
 - **Locale selection is required for all speakers.**

- If the value is pre-filled, verify it for correctness.
- In the **Accent Description** field, provide optional details about the speaker's regional accent.
 - Only fill this in if you're confident in identifying the specific regional variation.
 - Avoid repeating details already indicated by the Locale dropdown.
- Repeat the steps above for all remaining speakers in the unit.

Best Practice Tips:

- **Do not guess:** Only enter an Accent Description **when you are fairly certain of the region it represents.**
- Check for **sound quality issues** and verify you can clearly hear the speaker before labeling.
- When in doubt between two regions, default to **Locale-level only** and leave the Accent Description blank.

Examples of Locale and Accent Labeling

The examples below show correct use of the Locale and Accent Description fields. Identify each dialect based on speaker traits and clear audio. Only add an Accent Description when you feel confident about the regional variation.

► Example 1: English Locale and Accent Example

This image shows an example where the annotator labeled speakers using English dialects from both the United States and Australia. The Locale and Accent Description fields have been used appropriately and verified for accuracy.

Speaker	Locale	Accent Description
Speaker1	English (Australia) — en-AU	If recognizable: e.g., Texan, Sicilian, Liverpool, North Germany...
Speaker2	English (United States) — en-US	Northeast
Speaker3	English (United States) — en-US	Southern California
Speaker4	English (United States) — en-US	If recognizable: e.g., Texan, Sicilian, Liverpool, North Germany...

In this example:

- The annotator correctly labeled **three speakers** as **English (United States): en-US** and **one speaker** as **English (Australia): en-AU**.
- **Accent Descriptions** were confidently entered for **two speakers** (“Northeast” and “Southern California”), while two fields were left blank due to uncertainty.
- This approach supports **consistency** and avoids introducing incorrect data by avoiding guesses.

► Example 2: Spanish Locale and Accent Example

This image shows an example of dialect identification for Spanish speakers from Mexico and Argentina. The annotator accurately used both the Locale dropdown and the Accent Description input based on detectable linguistic features.

Speaker Locale Identification

Speaker	Locale	Accent Description
Speaker1	Spanish (Mexico) – es-MX	Yucatan
Speaker2	Spanish (Mexico) – es-MX	Yucatan
Speaker3	Spanish (Mexico) – es-MX	Mexico City
Speaker4	Spanish (Argentina) – es-AR	Mendoza

In this example:

- The annotator identified **three speakers** as **Spanish (Mexico): es-MX** and **one speaker** as **Spanish (Argentina): es-AR**.
- They provided **Accent Descriptions** such as “Yucatán,” “Mexico City,” and “Mendoza” for the speakers confidently.

These examples reflect the standard of high-quality annotation expected in this task: confident Locale selection, measured use of Accent Descriptions, and attention to audio clarity and accuracy.

Quality Expectations

To ensure high-quality annotations, please follow these standards:

Criteria	Expectation
Accuracy	Correctly identify the speaker's locale and accent based on clearly audible cues.
Completeness	Ensure all speakers are assessed; every Locale field must be completed.
Reliability	Only include Accent Descriptions you are confident in. Uncertainty harms data integrity.

Additional Notes

- Do not include duplicate or irrelevant comments in the Accent Description box.
- All assessments are subject to **Quality Review** by project leads.
- **Only click submit** once every speaker in the unit is fully reviewed.

Transcription Summary

Use this checklist to ensure your unit meets all quality and client requirements before submitting your work.

Listening & Tagging

- Listen to the audio before editing.
- Use playback tools (zoom/speed) if needed for clarity.
- Transcribe everything heard.
- Apply all tags consistently and in the correct language.
- Label Speech Style only if it is clear and unmistakable. Leave it blank if unsure.
- Focus on primary tone or emotion. Do not overanalyze.

Transcript Accuracy

- Make sure transcriptions match the segmented audio exactly.

- Include all spoken words.
- Do not omit, mishear, or reorder speech.
- Use tags appropriately: [laugh], [cough], [background music], <unintelligible/>,etc.
- Do not use speaker labels within the transcription box like "Speaker 1" or "Speaker 2."

Spelling & Formatting

- Spell all words correctly.
- Use proper punctuation and capitalization.
- Use digits for all numbers (e.g., 12, 5.5).
- Write out "dollars" instead of using the "\$" symbol.
- Spell the names of famous people and places correctly. Use Google to verify when unsure.
- Follow the spelling and writing rules of the target language.
- Use hashtags # # for foreign/code-switched words with no equivalent in the target language
- Use *asterisks* around elongated vowel syllables (e.g., s*o* fun), not repeated letters (e.g., sooo)
- Use 3 asterisks on each side for clearly emphasized words (***WOW***)

Accent Identification

- All sample audio clips have been listened to completely
- A Locale has been selected for every speaker. Any pre-filled values have been verified
- Accent Descriptions have only been entered when there is high confidence in the specific regional accent
- No Accent Descriptions include uncertain or unverifiable regional guesses
- Audio quality has been checked to confirm that the speaker's voice is clear enough for dialect assessment
- The confirmation box has been checked to indicate that all annotations have been reviewed

Final Validation Best Practices

The Final Validation task has a few special rules that are different from the usual annotation work. Please follow these carefully.

Background Noise Overlapping Speech

If you notice background sounds, such as music or crowd noise, overlapping speech but the audio was not originally segmented for it:

- Create a new region for the noise.
- Label it with [background music], [crowd noise], etc., in the noise field.
- There is no need to add <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tag for any noise segments that overlap speech.

Example:

- Speaker 1: Hi how are you?
- Noise: [background music]

Overlapping Speech That Was Not Previously Segmented

When overlapping speech and speaker noises ([cough], [laugh], [clearing throat], etc.) were missed during initial segmentation, and two speakers are clearly speaking at the same time follow these steps:

- Create a new region for the overlapping speech.
- Use <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tags in both regions to precisely mark where the overlap begins and ends.
- The tag should be applied only when both speakers are speaking simultaneously. One person speaks over part of the other's phrase.
- Think of it like puzzle pieces: the tags help map out exactly where the overlap happens across both records.
- In the examples below – look at the colors of speakers and how each speaker's overlapping transcription mirrors the other based on color of the text.

- Each `<nonprimaryspeakertalking>` tag must have a matching overlap in the other speaker's segment.

Noise & Nonprimaryspeakertalking Tags Are Mutually Exclusive

When you annotate a region of **noise** that overlaps speech, do NOT wrap that noise in a `<nonprimaryspeakertalking>` tag.

- The `<nonprimaryspeakertalking>` tag should **only be used for overlapping speakers speaking, and speaker noises** like [cough], [laugh], [sneeze] made from speakers.
- Non-verbal audio (e.g., background music, WhatsApp Chime, dog barking) should be marked in the noise segment only *without* `<nonprimaryspeakertalking>` tags.

Overlapping Speech Examples

Example 1 (2 Speakers Overlapping):

Imagine the audio has the following real-time overlap:

- Speaker 1 says: "Hi how are you"
- Speaker 2 says: "Hey" (starting where Speaker 1 says "how")

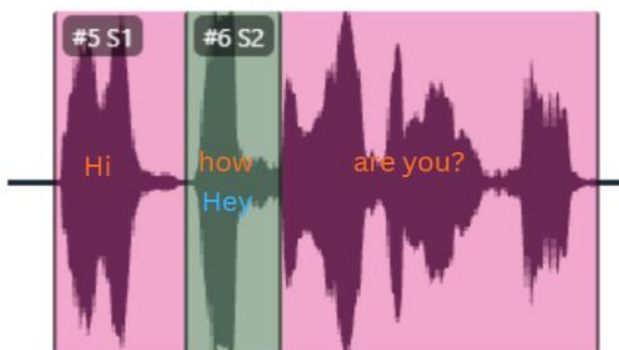
The overlapping part is "how" (Speaker 1) and "Hey" (Speaker 2) — these occur at the same time.

You'll transcribe:

- **Speaker 1:** Hi how `<nonprimaryspeakertalking>` Hey `</nonprimaryspeakertalking>` are you?
- **Speaker 2:** `<nonprimaryspeakertalking>` how `</nonprimaryspeakertalking>` Hey

Speaker 1 In ORANGE is saying: "Hi, how are you?"
Speaker 2 In BLUE is saying "Hey" at the same Speaker 1 is saying the word "how" causing an overlap

Segmentation



Speaker 2's "Hey" overlaps Speaker 1's "how"

Transcription

2	Speaker 1	neutral	Hi how <nonprimaryspeakertalking> Hey </nonprimaryspeakertalking> are you?	NonPrimary
3	Speaker 2	neutral	<nonprimaryspeakertalking>how </nonprimaryspeakertalking> Hey	NonPrimary

Note: Each speaker's transcription box begins with **Speaker 1's transcription in orange**. Not only does this make it easier to follow when transcribing <nonprimaryspeakertalking>, ensuring the transcription remains in order across all speakers is essential whenever overlapping speech occurs.

Additional Notes:

1. You transcribe only what is spoken within this specific region. In this case, Speaker 1 says "how" but since "Hi" is said before the overlap starts, it's not including within the <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tags.
2. The <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tags mark the exact span of the overlap. This creates a clear mapping between the two speakers.

Example 2 (Overlapping speech for a longer duration):

If both speakers are talking over the same line for a longer duration:

- **Speaker 1:** I want to go to the store <nonprimaryspeakertalking> I have to get a few items. </nonprimaryspeakertalking> I was thinking the same thing.
- **Speaker 2:** <nonprimaryspeakertalking> I want to go to the store </nonprimaryspeakertalking> I have to get a few items.

This indicates that the phrase “*I have to get a few items.*” by Speaker 2 and “*I want to go to the store.*” by Speaker 1 occur simultaneously. Each side of the overlap is wrapped properly with <nonprimaryspeakertalking>.

Speaker 1 in ORANGE is saying: “I want to go to the store. I was thinking the same thing.”
Speaker 2 in BLUE is saying “I have to get a few items.” at the same Speaker 1 is saying “I want to go to the store” causing an overlap

Segmentation



There are no gaps of silence from either speaker longer than 2 seconds inside the segment in this example.

Transcription

2	Speaker 1	neutral	I want to go to the store. <nonprimaryspeakertalking>I have to get a few items.</nonprimaryspeakertalking> I was thinking the same thing.		NonPrimary
3	Speaker 2	neutral	<nonprimaryspeakertalking>I want to go to the store.</nonprimaryspeakertalking> I have to get a few items.		NonPrimary

Reminder: Only use <nonprimaryspeakertalking> where two speakers’ words actually overlap in time. **This is not to mark interruptions that follow each other sequentially.** This tag is for true simultaneous speech only.

Example 3 (3 Speakers Overlapping / unintelligible speech):

If 3 speakers are talking over the same line for a longer duration with unintelligible speech:

- **Speaker 1:** This is my cat <unintelligible/> <nonprimaryspeakertalking> How <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking> <nonprimaryspeakertalking> I was <unintelligible/> to </nonprimaryspeakertalking> Fluffy.
- **Speaker 2:** <nonprimaryspeakertalking> This is my cat <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking> How <unintelligible/> <nonprimaryspeakertalking> I was <unintelligible/> to </nonprimaryspeakertalking>
- **Speaker 3:** <nonprimaryspeakertalking> This is my cat <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking> <nonprimaryspeakertalking> How <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking> I was <unintelligible/> to

This indicates that the phrase “This is my cat <unintelligible/>” by Speaker 1, “How <unintelligible/>” by Speaker 2 , and “I was <unintelligible/> to.” by Speaker 3 occur simultaneously. Each side of all overlaps are wrapped properly with <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tags. Notice how each speakers transcription follows the same order: **Speaker 1 in Orange**, **Speaker 2 in Blue**, **Speaker 3 in Purple**.

Speaker 1 in ORANGE is saying: “This is my cat <unintelligible/> Fluffy.”
Speaker 2 in YELLOW is saying “How <unintelligible/> did you”
Speaker 3 in Purple is saying “I was <unintelligible/> to”
 All 3 speakers are overlapping - only the word “Fluffy” from Speaker 1 doesn't have any overlapping speech
 Note the three segments below span the entirety of the overlap

Segmentation



Due to 3 speakers talking at the same time, <unintelligible/> tags are used for words that are difficult to understand with all of the overlap

There are no gaps of silence from either speaker longer than 2 seconds inside the segment in this example.

All 3 speakers are simulatneously speaking overtop of one another with the exception of **Speaker 1's final word: Fluffy.**

18	Speaker 1	neutral	This is my cat <unintelligible/> <nonprimaryspeakertalking>How <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking>How <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking>I was <unintelligible/> to</nonprimaryspeakertalking>Fluffy.	Search Play Stop T+ T-	NonPrimary Unintelligible
19	Speaker 2	neutral	<nonprimaryspeakertalking>This is my cat <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking>How <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking>I was <unintelligible/> to </nonprimaryspeakertalking>	Search Play Stop T+ T-	NonPrimary Unintelligible
20	Speaker 3	neutral	<nonprimaryspeakertalking>This is my cat <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking> <nonprimaryspeakertalking>How <unintelligible/> </nonprimaryspeakertalking>I was <unintelligible/> to	Search Play Stop T+ T-	NonPrimary Unintelligible

Example 4 (overlapping speech that starts mid-word):

If 2 speakers are talking over each other, but Speaker 2 begins speaking halfway through Speaker 1's current word:

Segment and Transcribe the full word where the overlap begins.

- Speaker 1: Flowers** <nonprimaryspeakertalking> **Oh!** </nonprimaryspeakertalking> are red.

- **Speaker 2:** <nonprimaryspeakertalking> Flowers </nonprimaryspeakertalking> Oh!

Speaker 1 in ORANGE is saying: "Flowers are red."
Speaker 2 in BLUE is saying "Oh!"
Speaker 2 says "Oh!" halfway through Speaker 1 saying "Flowers".

Segmentation



Transcription

8	Speaker 1	neutral	Flowers <nonprimaryspeakertalking> Oh! <nonprimaryspeakertalking> are red	NP X T
9	Speaker 2	neutral	<nonprimaryspeakertalking> Flowers <nonprimaryspeakertalking> Oh!	NP X T

Summary Reminders:

- Tag speaker overlaps precisely using <nonprimaryspeakertalking>, and only for actual speech/speaker noises.
- Separate background noise as its own region—never include it with a speaker transcription.
- Every <nonprimaryspeakertalking> tag should have a corresponding segment from the other speaker indicating matched overlapping areas.
- Transcription for each speaker's overlap should lay on top of each other and match the transcription order of joining boxes. If Speaker 1's transcription begins with Speaker 1's speech, Speaker 2 should follow the same path and start with Speaker 1's speech like below. Speaker 1's speech **begins both transcriptions**, and is **orange in color**.
 - **Speaker 1:** I want to go to the store<nonprimaryspeakertalking> I have to get a few items. </nonprimaryspeakertalking> I was thinking the same thing.
 - **Speaker 2:** <nonprimaryspeakertalking> I want to go to the store </nonprimaryspeakertalking> I have to get a few items.

Please ensure that all guidelines are followed consistently. If clarification is needed, contact the project team via the [Help Desk](#) or on [Teams](#).

